HemOncKB README

Version 2.1 (last updated 2026-03-13)

The purpose of this document is to provide brief descriptions of the files available in the HemOnc Dataverse repository, and to provide links to additional guidance documents. Refer to the full set of tables section for naming conventions and file formats. Due to the constantly evolving nature of the HemOncKB and supporting guidance documents, we are utilizing the Google Docs platform to house additional guidance documents, which will not be versioned but will include a “last updated” date at the beginning. Links to the relevant Google Docs are provided in this document.

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Data Dictionary

Details about the tables and variables that together comprise the HemOncKB, as well as the current maturity level and content of the tables, are described in the **data.dictionary** file.

Further guidance is available through a dedicated Google Doc (opens in browser).

Core Content Tables and Data Model

The core content of the HemOncKB is represented in OMOP format in three tables: **concept_stage**, **concept_relationship_stage**, and **concept_synonym_stage**. The tables available through the HemOnc Dataverse are versioned with a timestamp in the file name itself, following the convention "**YYYY-MM-DD HH-MM-SS.table_name.tab**". Accompanying these tables is a "what's new" Excel spreadsheet, following the convention "**YYYY-MM-DD HH-MM-SS.whats_new.xlsx**". This spreadsheet has short summaries of the major quarter-on-quarter changes as well as changes in counts of concepts and relationships compared to the most recent official release.

The data model constraining the core content tables is defined in three tables: 1) **hemonc_classes** defines *all* HemOncKB concept classes; 2) **hemonc_rels** defines the *core* HemOncKB relationship types; and 3) **canonical.triples** provides the full set of allowed concept class 1-relationship-concept class 2 triples. All of these tables also include deprecated concepts with the date of deprecation.

There is no further guidance for these tables beyond the data dictionary overview document (opens in browser).

Additional Tables

The additional (previously referred to as ancillary) tables of the HemOncKB contain a large amount of information that is difficult to represent in the standard OMOP *concept-relationship-concept* format. These tables are often the source for the OMOP table content and are thus a critical part of the overall HemOncKB. They can be grouped as described in the next sections:

Studies

The primarily prospective clinical trials (studies) that inform the evidence base for the HemOncKB are represented in two tables: 1) **studies** contains definitional values for a study, including its unique name, clinical trial registration number (if available), and phase; and 2) **study_results** contains published results of studies with an initial focus on the primary endpoint(s) of randomized clinical trials (RCTs).

There is no further guidance for these tables beyond the data dictionary overview document (opens in browser).

Publications and Authors

The **refs** table contains contextually anchored publication information. Because a single manuscript may report on multiple studies and/or conditions, and because there may be multiple manuscripts reporting on a single study (e.g., primary publications and updates), there are some many:many relationships with **studies**. For each published manuscript, the authors' name(s), role(s), order(s), and affiliation(s) are captured in **authors**. Note that extensive cleaning is required to normalize names and affiliations, such that the information here will often not directly match information from MEDLINE, which is the primary source for most of the entries. The **persons** table contains summarized information about individual authors, one row per author.

There is no further guidance for these tables beyond the data dictionary overview document (opens in browser).

Conditions

All benign and malignant disease conditions present in the HemOncKB have an entry in the **conditions** table, which also contains internal grouping definitions and mappings to several external vocabularies.

There is no further guidance for this table beyond the data dictionary overview document (opens in browser).

Drugs

All drugs present in the HemOncKB have an entry in the **drugs** table, which also contains international normalized names (INNs) and mappings to several external vocabularies. The table **rxnorm_map** contains mappings from HemOncKB drugs to RxNorm semantic types.

Regulatory indication information is represented in the **indications** table, with a primary focus of capturing label information for antineoplastic drugs.

Further guidance is available through a dedicated Google Doc (opens in browser).

SIGs and Regimens

The **sigs** table contains granular dosing and timing information for regimens. ***This is the most complicated HemOncKB table, and users are highly recommended to read the additional guidance before using this table***. The derived **variants** table contains a versioned roll-up of the regimen details in **sigs**, along with several indicators of sig completeness. The **variant_eligibility** table contains specific dosing criteria for regimens with age-specific, weight-specific, or similar restrictions. The **regimens** table is derived from other tables and contains high-level information such as regimen type and number of variants per regimen.

Further guidance is available through a dedicated Google Doc (opens in browser).

Knowledge Management

The purpose of these tables is to increase the transparency of our knowledge management process, which involves extensive literature review and application of our eligibility criteria, which are defined further on the HemOnc.org wiki:

There are currently two tables made available for public inspection: 1) the **inclusions** table lists references that have been included on HemOnc.org, along with reasons for why they were included; 2) the **exclusions** table lists references that have been reviewed and determined ineligible per the applied criteria in the HemOnc.org SOP, along with who performed the review. Note that a substantial number of exceptions to the SOP, e.g., non-randomized studies in a rare cancer, are present and these are further explained in the **inclusions** table.

Further guidance is available on HemOnc.org (opens in browser).

Linkages

Finally, the **pointers** table serves to link portions of the HemOncKB back to HemOnc.org, using the wiki Table of Contents (TOC) structure as the link. These links are subject to change over time as the wiki continues to evolve, such that the backlinks are versioned. (Note that in 2026, many changes were made for digital accessibility, which affected the TOC numbering such that older links are unlikely to be correct).

There is no further guidance for this table beyond the data dictionary overview document (opens in browser).

Full Set of Tables Included in Distribution

Name	Format	Type	Location
data.dictionary	.xlsx	Guidance	Base folder
whats_new[1]	.xlsx	Guidance	Base folder
HemOncKB README 2.0 (this file)	.pdf	Guidance	Base folder
concept_stage[1]	.tab[1]	Core OMOP	Base folder
concept_relationship_stage[1]	.tab[1]	Core OMOP	Base folder
concept_synonym_stage[1]	.tab[1]	Core OMOP	Base folder
hemonc_classes	.csv	Core OMOP	ZIP file[1]
hemonc_rels	.csv	Core OMOP	ZIP file[1]
canonical.triples	.csv	Core OMOP	ZIP file[1]
authors	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
conditions	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
drugs	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
indications	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
persons	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
refs	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
regimens	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
rxnorm_map	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
sigs	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
studies	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
study_results	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
variant_eligibility	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
variants	.csv	Ancillary	ZIP file[1]
pointers	.csv	Linkage	ZIP file[1]
exclusions	.csv	Knowledge Management	ZIP file[1]
inclusions	.csv	Knowledge Management	ZIP file[1]

[1]These files are all prefixed with a version string in YYYY-MM-DD HH-MM-SS format.

[2]These files are created in .csv format natively and transformed to .tab by Dataverse; to our knowledge, all formatting is preserved.

Version Tracker

Version	Description of changes
2.1	Minor changes to wording and link format in this document.
2.0	Regimens table added to description; table of tables and TOC added. This tracker added. Minor changes to wording.
1.1	Inclusions table added to the description; deferrals table removed (for internal use only). Minor changes to wording.
1.0	Initial version